

Proceedings of CHI 2025 · Microsoft Research × Carnegie Mellon

The Impact of Generative AI on Critical Thinking

Lee, H., et al. (2025)
Survey of 319 knowledge workers

KEY FINDING

When people trust the AI more, they **accept its answer at face value** — less checking, less scrutiny. When people trust themselves more, they **verify and question** what the AI gives them.

319

professionals surveyed

936

real AI use cases



Dr. H. Lee, lead author



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“Trust the AI more, and you stop checking its work. Trust YOURSELF more, and you start questioning it.”

— it's the confidence balance, not the AI, that drives the outcome

Source: Lee et al., “The Impact of Generative AI on Critical Thinking,” CHI 2025.